

HACK MATRIX 5.0

Team Guidelines:

- Team size must be 3 to 4 members.
- Every student must carry a valid Student ID Card for identification.
- Inter-college teams are allowed.
- An individual team member cannot be a member of more than one team.
- Team composition cannot be changed once registered.
- All team members must be present for the offline final round upon selection.

Tip: Assemble a team with members skilled in Frontend Development, Backend Development and AI/ML to ensure well-rounded collaboration.

Round-Wise Details

ROUND 01 (Online):

Round 1 will be conducted online and will consist of:

ROUND 1 - Idea, Prototype & Presentation Submission:

- Participants are required to submit an Idea Submission PPT based on the given problem statement, presenting a clear and innovative approach to the proposed solution. If the evaluators do not find a viable solution within any track, there may be no selection in that track.
- Teams must develop a working prototype with at least 30-40% of the proposed solution implemented and demonstrable.
- Teams must submit a video presenting both the PPT and the developed prototype.
- The proposed solution should clearly address the given problem statement and demonstrate potential for further development and implementation.
- The PPT must strictly follow the template provided by the organizing committee, with no additional slides.
- The proposed solution should be compatible with and scalable using AI & ML.
- Teams must submit the required PPT, prototype demonstration video and GitHub repository within the specified submission period.

Platform Of Submission:

(Registered Teams should only use their platform of registration for submission!)

- Unstop Submissions
- HackMatrix website (URL: [HackMatrix](#))

GitHub Setup:

- [GitHub Setup & Tutorial Video Link ↗](#)
- [GitHub Cheat Sheet ↗](#)

Guidelines for GitHub Repository:

- Only the Team Leader should create the GitHub repository.
- Other team members must be added as collaborators.
- The repository should initially be private, accessible only to team members, and must be made public before the submission of the Google Drive link, i.e. before the conclusion of the submission period (29 Sept 2026, 11:00 AM), so that it can be evaluated.
- **Do Not:** Commit zip files to the repository.
- Avoid committing compilation output files (e.g., .exe, .jar, .dll, etc.).
- Avoid committing videos or other large-sized files. Use services like Google Drive or Dropbox for sharing such files.
- Avoid unnecessary or trivial commits. Commits should represent logical and meaningful changes.
- A single team member committing all changes is not recommended.
- All team members must contribute to the repository. Lack of contribution from multiple members may negatively impact evaluation.

Violation of these rules may result in disqualification from the hackathon.

Timeline for ROUND 01:

Date	Time	Event
11 Sept 2026	11:00 AM	Problem Statement Release
28 Sept 2026	02:00 PM	Commencement of Submission Period
29 Sept 2026	11:00 AM	Conclusion of Submission Period

Presentation Guidelines:

- **Introduction of the Team:**
 - o Team name
 - o Team members
 - o Problem Statement + Track introduction.
- **Problem Statement:**
 - o Clearly explain the problem statement being addressed.
 - o Demonstrate understanding of the problem and its requirements.

- **Proposed Idea / Solution:**
 - o The idea must be explained using the points provided in the **official PPT template**.

PPT Structure:

- **Teams must use the provided PPT template.**
- **No additional slides may be added** to the Idea Submission PPT.
- The content should be concise, precise and directly relevant to the problem statement.
- Teams should avoid unnecessary content or information that does not contribute to explaining the proposed solution.

Submission Platform:

- Teams are supposed to create a Google Drive folder with their respective **Team_name and PS_id**.
(Example: teamName_PSid).
- Drive folder should include:
 1. **PPT regarding the selected Problem Statement.**
 2. **PPT and Prototype explanatory video.**
 3. **GitHub Link (For the Prototype). The repository must be made public before submission.**
- The video duration can be maximum of 3 mins.
- **Only the team leader** has to submit the Google Drive link on the HackMatrix Website submission portal or Unstop.
- Make sure the drive link is accessible for evaluation.

Evaluation Criteria for ROUND 01:

Criteria	Points	Criteria	Points
Innovativeness	10	UI/UX	15
Problem Understanding & Solution Fit	10	GitHub Maintenance	20
Tech Stack	15	Documentation	10
Presentation	10	Social Impact	10

Selection for Finals:

The top 8 teams from each track will advance to the final round.

Note: If no viable solution is found in a track, there may be no selections in that track.

○ ROUND 02 (Offline):**Guidelines:**

- All team members must be present.
- A working prototype (end product) of the proposed solution must be submitted, along with tasks assigned during the hackathon.
- Experienced experts and faculty in respective domains will evaluate the projects and their decision will be final.
- PowerPoint presentations must adhere to the provided template and be concise.
- All work on the project must be done during the hackathon.
- Time limits must be strictly adhered to; no extensions will be granted.
- Proposed solutions must integrate AI & ML.

Evaluation Criteria for ROUND 02:

1. **Innovativeness:** Creativity and originality of the solution.
 2. **Tech Stack:** Effective use of modern technologies and tools.
 3. **Presentation:** Clarity, organization, and delivery of the idea.
 4. **UI/UX:** User-friendly design and seamless user experience.
 5. **AI & ML Integration:** Quality and depth of AI/ML components integrated into the solution.
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Timeline for ROUND 02:

Date	Time	Event
10 Oct 2026	08:00 AM	Breakfast
10 Oct 2026	09:00 AM	Opening Note & Kick-off
10 Oct 2026	01:00 PM	Lunch
10 Oct 2026	02:00 PM	Mentoring Round
10 Oct 2026	08:00 PM	Dinner
10 Oct 2026	09:00 PM	Overnight Coding Resumes
11 Oct 2026	09:00 AM	Breakfast
11 Oct 2026	11:00 AM	Final Evaluation

Winner Criteria:

- One winner will be selected from each domain based on evaluations by the judges.

General Instructions:

- All participants must comply with the rules and guidelines established by the organizing committee.
- Inappropriate behaviour toward other teams is strictly prohibited and may result in disqualification.
- Disqualification decisions are at the discretion of the organizers for reasons such as rule violations, unsporting behaviour, or misconduct.
- Judges' decisions are final and binding.
- Registration fees are non-refundable under any circumstances.
- Malpractices during the hackathon are strictly prohibited.
- Prioritize safety and report unsafe conditions to the organizers.
- Female participants will be required to shift to the girls' hostel after dinner in Round 02, as per institutional safety and accommodation policies.
- Participants are allowed to take part in other events happening simultaneously.